

BRECKSVILLE - BROADVIEW HEIGHTS

CITY SCHOOL DISTRICT



TITLE I PROGRAM

PARENT INVOLVEMENT POLICY

AND HANDBOOK

2020 - 2021

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Rationale

Section 1118 of the Improving America's Schools Act of 1994 relates to parent involvement policies. Under this section the law specifically defines how schools and parents must work together for the benefit of students. Section 1118 requires a written parent involvement policy that is to be developed with parents to explain how they can be more involved in their children's education and schools. In order to fulfill the requirements of Section 1118 of the federal law, a Parent Involvement Team that included parents from Title I buildings, Title I teachers, and the Title I Coordinator, has developed this handbook to enhance parents' understanding, involvement, and communication with the schools. Title I holds that parents have a *right* to be involved with decisions regarding the Title I Program, while at the same time, they have the *responsibility* to help their children succeed in school.

The Title I Parent Involvement Handbook will be updated yearly and distributed to all teachers and parents of Title I students. Modifications made to the policy handbook will be based on recommendations made by the Parent Involvement Team as they reflect on parental input, results of the yearly Needs Assessment, and changes in the federal law. The handbook will be available to other parents and community members upon request. Topics included in the handbook are a calendar of important dates, a description of Title I, eligibility, services, assessments, and compacts, along with other pertinent information for parents. This Title I handbook will supplement the information found in your school's Parent Handbook.

Description of Title I

Title I is the largest federal aid program for schools. The government provides schools with funding, based on the number of low-income families in a district, for extra educational services to children who are behind their peers in academic achievement. Title I in the Brecksville-Broadview Heights District generally serves children at the elementary level in reading and language arts.

The goal of Title I is to help students in the program to reach the state's educational standards, as is the district goal for all students. Standards describe what students should know and be able to do at each grade level. Standards are set by the local school system and the state and are delineated in the district's courses of study. The courses of study can be found on the district web site (www.bbhcsc.org). Parents are welcome to review the courses of study at any time for any curricular area.

District Eligibility for Title I Funds

The funding a district receives is based on the percentage of low-income families living within the district. This number is determined by a combination of students on free and reduced lunches, those who receive Aid to Dependent Children, and students who are homeless or delinquent. The number of students who are disadvantaged must be at least 5% of the district's total population.

Eligibility of Students

Students who are furthest behind in school are eligible for Title I services, regardless of their family's income. Students qualify for services with standardized reading test scores at the 40th percentile or lower and/or with teacher checklists of grade level skills and concepts. Students are generally identified in the spring for fall placement and may only be placed in the program with parental consent. Students exit from the program when Title I and classroom teachers feel sufficient progress has been made towards meeting the standards and when students test at or above the expected benchmark goals. Parental consent is not required for withdrawal from the program.

Title I Services

Students in the Title I Program in grades K-3 typically receive at least 120 minutes of instruction per week. This small group supplemental instruction occurs mostly in the Title I room, but some instruction may occur in the classroom as well. The type of service that

students receive is determined by individual needs. Students in grades 4 and 5 may receive similar services as above or be placed on a team where they can receive their language arts instruction in the Title I classroom combined with inclusion where the Title I teacher team teaches with the other language arts teacher on the team.

Assessment of Achievement

Every student in the BBHCSD is assessed each year. The purpose of these assessments are to determine a student's academic success. Students in grades three through eight will take the American Institute for Research (AIR) tests. Additionally, Kindergarten through fifth grade students are assessed three times a year using the iReady assessment to determine mastery of reading skills. Parents will be provided the results of all the assessments. Questions pertaining to testing results can be addressed by the classroom and/or Title 1 teacher.

Title I Compacts

The Title 1 Program uses a "compact" to focus on a child's success in school. A compact is an individualized plan for parents, principals and teachers to assist each student, including self help. These compacts are based on each student's yearly needs. If necessary, a compact can be modified according to student progression.

Parent Resources

To reach greater parent involvement in the education of children, barriers that keep some parents from participating must be removed or minimized. Examples include limited English proficiency, racial and ethnic issues, handicaps, limited literacy, etc. In efforts to alleviate these issues, the Parent Involvement Team is and will continue to search for resources to assist parents with overcoming the barriers to their full participation. Resource information will be kept in a folder in the Title I Coordinator's Office. Examples of resources are the Special Education Resource Center (SERC) and local departments of human services. Any parent needing assistance in any area is encouraged to call their school's Title I teacher, principal, or the district coordinator. Attempts will be made to match area resources to the needs of parents.

Parent Dissatisfaction

Any parent who is not happy with the Title I program or the Parent Involvement Policy and Handbook for Title I may register their concerns in writing. These concerns will be shared with and addressed by the building principal, the coordinator of the Title I Program, and the Title I teachers.

District's Mission Statement

The mission of the Brecksville-Broadview Heights City School District is to inspire and prepare students to be lifelong learners, to be flexible in approaching opportunities for growth, and to be effective as well as ethical contributors to our society.

PARENT INFORMATION CALENDAR

Please verify all calendar dates and times with your child's school.

PARENT-TEACHER CONFERENCES

You may meet with the Title I teacher separately or in conjunction with the classroom teacher.

Middle School: TBD - Parents will be notified.

Highland Drive School: TBD - Parents will be notified.

Hilton Elementary School: TBD - Parents will be notified.

ADDITIONAL ACTIVITIES

Occasionally, extra reading activities may be scheduled by your school, PSO, and/or the Title I team. If such an activity is scheduled, you will be notified through newsletters, flyers, and/or teacher emails.

DISTRICT-WIDE TESTING

All students participate in State and/or Standardized Testing. Grade 3 will be testing in October. AIR, DIBELS and iReady results, as well as teacher evaluation of classroom performance, will be used to qualify for Title I services the following year.

ANNUAL NEEDS ASSESSMENT SURVEY

During May, parents and teachers of Title I students will be asked to fill out the annual Needs Assessment/Evaluation Survey. The results of this data are compiled and used to make decisions for improvement of the program and parent involvement. Title I students will be bringing the survey home for their parents sometime in May. Please return it in the attached envelope by the due date. If you do not receive one, call your child's Title I teacher.

END-OF-YEAR

Sometime in May or June, permission letters for future Title I services will go home. It is very beneficial for each school to know who will be in Title I classes the following year as scheduling for the next year begins at the end of the current year. Please sign and return these permission letters before the end of the school year.

TITLE I STAFF

Teachers:

Missy Doherty, Highland Drive Elementary
Fran Eichelberger, Hilton Elementary
Stefanie Fechko, Middle School
Kristin La, Hilton Elementary
Emilia Snitil, Online Learning
Jill Tomford, Highland Drive Elementary

Director of Curriculum & Instruction:

Dr. David Martin

DIRECTIONS TO TITLE I SCHOOL BUILDINGS

All directions given below start from the intersection of
Royalton Road (Route 82) and Brecksville Road (Route 21).

Brecksville-Broadview Heights Middle School

6376 Mill Road
Broadview Heights, OH 44147
440-740-4400
Mr. Todd Rings, Principal

Go north on 21. Turn left on Mill Road. The school is ahead on the left.

Highland Drive Elementary School

9457 Highland Drive
Brecksville, OH 44141
440-740-4300
Mrs. Colleen Toth, Principal

Go west on Rt. 82. Turn left at first light onto Highland Drive.
Continue down Highland Drive through the Oakes Road intersection.
The school is about 1/8 mile ahead on the left.

Hilton Elementary School

6812 Mill Road
Brecksville, OH 44141
440-740-4600
Mr. Chris Hartland, Principal

Go north on 21. Turn left on Mill Road. The school is ahead on the left.